

Julie Burkey

Enterprise Technology, Communications & AI Portfolio

Architecture | AI & Quality | UC/CC | Technical Delivery

About Me

For more than 20 years, I have helped organizations design, implement, validate, and modernize enterprise communications and contact center solutions. My career spans enterprise voice, Unified Communications (UCaaS), Contact Center (CCaaS), cloud migrations, AI-enabled customer experiences, systems integration, and large-scale technology delivery across Fortune 500 organizations.

I enjoy working at the intersection of business and technology - understanding operational challenges, translating them into practical technical solutions, and staying involved from evaluation and proof of concept through testing, production readiness, deployment, troubleshooting, and continuous improvement.

More recently, my work has expanded across conversational AI, agentic AI, and AI agent-assist initiatives. That experience reinforced an approach I have used throughout my career: technology quality depends not only on whether a solution works as designed, but on how it behaves in real-world and unexpected situations.

This portfolio highlights representative projects that demonstrate my approach to architecture, AI evaluation, systems validation, technical delivery, and continuous improvement.

Core Areas of Expertise

Architecture	Enterprise Solution Architecture • Contact Center Architecture • UCaaS / CCaaS • Enterprise Voice & SIP • Cloud Communications
AI & Quality	Conversational AI • Agentic AI • AI Agent Assist • AI Quality & Evaluation • Scenario & Edge-Case Testing
Validation	Systems Validation • Integration Testing • Production Readiness • POC / Technology Evaluation • Root Cause Analysis
Delivery	Enterprise Migrations • Technical Leadership • Vendor Evaluation • Cross-Functional Collaboration • Agile / Jira

Featured Project 1: Enterprise Conversational AI Modernization

Company: Datavant **Role:** Senior Contact Center Solutions Architect

Business Challenge

Modernize a traditional IVR environment with conversational AI to improve customer experience, increase self-service and call containment, reduce reliance on live agents, and create measurable operational value while maintaining enterprise reliability and production readiness.

My Role & Responsibilities

- Led the solution from proof of concept through production deployment, aligning business objectives, technical requirements, integrations, and operational needs.
- Partnered with business stakeholders, product owners, engineering teams, vendors, and contact center operations to define goals, success measures, and implementation requirements.
- Designed and supported integrations across Cognigy conversational AI, NICE CXone, RingCentral, SIP, and supporting business applications.
- Created architecture diagrams, solution documentation, implementation guidance, and operational support materials.
- Coordinated testing, performance validation, production readiness, deployment, and post-production optimization.

AI Quality & Ongoing Evaluation

My involvement continued after the initial production launch. I regularly tested the conversational AI experience to identify unexpected behavior and opportunities for improvement, with particular attention to scenarios that might not appear in standard scripted testing.

- Performed ongoing scenario-based testing across expected workflows, unexpected interactions, and edge cases.
- Developed test scenarios reflecting different user characteristics and contexts, including age, communication approach, and user role such as patients and medical-facility personnel.
- Evaluated AI responses, conversation flows, routing behavior, integrations, and overall user experience.
- Looked beyond the expected path to identify where phrasing, context, user behavior, or workflow variations could produce an unexpected result.
- Recommended enhancements based on testing observations, interaction analytics, operational feedback, and real-world user scenarios.

Technologies

NICE CXone • Cognigy Conversational AI • RingCentral • SIP • Cloud Communications • Enterprise Integrations

Featured Project 1: Outcomes & Lessons

Business Outcome

The project transformed a traditional IVR into a modern conversational AI solution designed to deliver more natural customer interactions, expand self-service, improve containment, and provide a scalable foundation for future AI initiatives.

The initiative also established a repeatable approach to continuous optimization using interaction analytics, operational observations, testing, and refinement rather than treating production deployment as the end of the project.

Quality Perspective

One of the most important lessons was that AI quality cannot be evaluated only against the expected or 'happy' path. Users vary in age, role, communication style, terminology, intent, and how they respond to prompts. Effective evaluation requires deliberately exploring those differences and observing how the AI behaves when conversations do not follow the anticipated pattern.

Key Takeaways

- Successful AI implementations are driven by business outcomes, not simply by deploying new technology.
- Production launch is the beginning of AI optimization, not the end.
- Continuous testing and interaction analysis help expose scenarios that scripted test cases may miss.
- Improving containment and user experience requires collaboration across business, operations, developers, vendors, and technical teams.
- AI quality is closely tied to context: the same workflow may need to behave appropriately for very different users and interaction patterns.

Additional AI Initiatives & Quality Evaluation

Outbound Agentic AI - Medical Records Collection

Participated in the development and evaluation of an outbound agentic AI application designed to interact with medical providers to facilitate medical-record collection.

- Contributed technical and contact-center perspective to an AI-driven outbound workflow.
- Supported solution evaluation and consideration of how the application would operate within real-world provider interactions and existing communications processes.
- Applied experience with call flows, integrations, routing, and production operations when evaluating the solution.

AI Agent Assist - Knowledge & Post-Call Automation POC

Participated in a proof of concept for an AI agent-assist application intended to provide relevant knowledge based on call type and generate post-call summaries for agents.

- Evaluated a concept in which call type and interaction context could surface relevant knowledge for the agent.
- Participated in evaluation of automated post-call summaries for agent review and copy/paste into CRM.
- Considered the longer-term opportunity to automate CRM updates after appropriate validation and workflow maturity.
- Brought contact-center architecture, integration, workflow, and operational experience to the POC.

Applied AI Experience

Conversational AI	Customer/patient interactions • Conversation flows • Containment • Scenario testing • Continuous optimization
Agentic AI	Outbound workflow • Provider interaction • Medical-record collection • Operational integration
Agent Assist	Knowledge support • Call-type context • Post-call summaries • Human review • Future CRM automation
Quality Mindset	Unexpected scenarios • Edge cases • User context • Response evaluation • Enhancement recommendations

Featured Project 2: Large-Scale UCaaS & CCaaS Customer Deployments

Company: Fuze **Role:** Senior Network Consultant

Business Challenge

Organizations were transitioning from legacy telephony to cloud-based Unified Communications and Contact Center platforms. Each environment introduced different network, voice, integration, operational, and deployment risks that needed to be identified before production cutover.

My Role & Responsibilities

- Supported more than 500 enterprise customer deployments.
- Performed network readiness assessments and voice-quality evaluations.
- Provided architecture guidance, deployment planning, and technical consulting.
- Supported implementation testing, production cutovers, stabilization, and post-implementation troubleshooting.
- Resolved complex voice-quality, SIP, routing, connectivity, and network issues.
- Worked closely with project managers, implementation teams, vendors, and customer technical staff.

Quality & Validation Perspective

Although this work was not performed under a formal QA title, validation was embedded throughout the delivery lifecycle. Readiness assessments, testing, cutover validation, stabilization, and root-cause analysis were essential to determining whether each environment was prepared for production.

Technologies

Fuze UCaaS • NICE inContact / CXone • Five9 • SIP • VoIP • Enterprise Networking

Key Takeaway

Supporting hundreds of deployments reinforced that no two customer environments behave exactly alike. Reliable delivery requires structured validation, adaptability, communication, and the willingness to investigate unexpected behavior rather than assuming a standard design will behave identically everywhere.

Featured Project 3: Enterprise Contact Center & Voice Modernization

Company: Volkswagen Financial Services **Role:** Telecom Lead Architect

Business Challenge

Modernize aging telecommunications infrastructure across North American contact centers while improving resiliency, enabling future growth, and supporting a more flexible workforce.

My Role & Responsibilities

- Led replacement of a carrier-grade Alcatel PCX telephony environment with Cisco CUCM.
- Designed redundant voice architecture supporting business continuity across contact centers and regional locations.
- Managed deployment of Verint call recording.
- Led Genesys contact center upgrades and VoIP optimization initiatives.
- Coordinated vendor implementations and cross-functional technical teams.
- Supported remote-agent capabilities well before widespread remote work became common.

Technologies

Cisco CUCM • Cisco Webex • Genesys • Verint • SIP • VoIP • Enterprise Voice

Business Outcome

Delivered a modern enterprise voice platform with improved resiliency, optimized licensing, enhanced contact-center capabilities, and infrastructure capable of supporting remote work across North American operations.

Key Takeaway

Large infrastructure transformations depend on planning, risk management, stakeholder alignment, testing, and operational readiness. Architecture is not only about designing the target state; it is also about ensuring the solution can be introduced safely and supported after deployment.

Featured Project 4: Enterprise Unified Communications Transformation

Company: CareerBuilder **Role:** Senior Unified Communications Engineer

Business Challenge

Modernize an enterprise voice environment while evaluating next-generation Unified Communications platforms to support future business growth, scalability, and collaboration.

My Role & Responsibilities

- Managed Avaya upgrades including Session Manager and System Manager.
- Led SIP trunk implementation.
- Evaluated multiple UCaaS and CCaaS platforms through proof-of-concept initiatives.
- Supported migration planning from legacy telephony to cloud communications.
- Partnered with infrastructure teams to improve reliability and scalability.

Technologies

Avaya Aura • Session Manager • System Manager • SIP • RingCentral • Interactive Intelligence • Microsoft • Fuze

Business Outcome

Positioned the organization for a long-term transition from traditional enterprise telephony to modern cloud communications while improving scalability and operational flexibility.

Quality & Evaluation Perspective

Platform POCs required more than feature comparison. Evaluating technology meant validating whether a solution could meet real business requirements, integrate into the existing environment, support users effectively, and scale beyond the initial evaluation.

Key Takeaway

Technology evaluation should focus on long-term business value, operational fit, user adoption, integration requirements, reliability, and future scalability - not simply whether a product performs well in a controlled demonstration.

How I Approach Technology Quality

Across architecture, communications, and AI initiatives, quality has been a consistent part of my work even when it was not reflected in my job title.

Understand	Clarify the business problem • Identify users and stakeholders • Define requirements and expected outcomes
Evaluate	POCs • Technology comparison • Scenario testing • Integration validation • Readiness assessment
Challenge	Test assumptions • Explore edge cases • Consider unexpected user behavior • Look across system boundaries
Deploy	Production readiness • Cutover support • Operational documentation • Cross-functional coordination
Improve	Troubleshooting • Root-cause analysis • Interaction analytics • Feedback • Continuous optimization

Leadership Philosophy

Successful architecture and technology delivery are built on collaboration as much as technology. The best solutions begin with understanding the business problem, engaging stakeholders early, and designing practical approaches that balance user experience, operational efficiency, reliability, and long-term sustainability.

Whether leading enterprise migrations, implementing conversational AI, evaluating emerging AI applications, modernizing contact centers, or supporting cloud communications, my goal is the same: deliver technology that creates measurable business value and works reliably for the people who depend on it.

Technical Expertise

Contact Center	NICE CXone • Genesys • Five9 • Verint • Interactive Intelligence
Unified Comms	RingCentral • Cisco CUCM • Microsoft Teams • Zoom • Fuze • Avaya • Cisco Webex
AI	Cognigy • Conversational AI • Agentic AI • AI Agent Assist • AI Evaluation
Architecture	CCaaS • UCaaS • Enterprise Voice • SIP • VoIP • Cloud Communications • Enterprise Integrations
Delivery & Quality	POC Evaluation • Scenario Testing • Systems Validation • Production Readiness • Root Cause Analysis • Agile • Jira

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